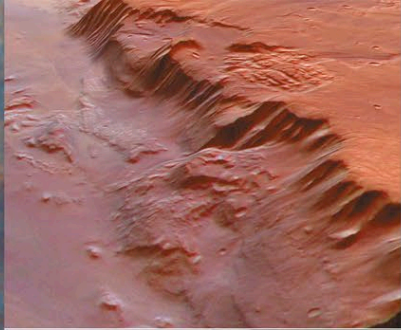
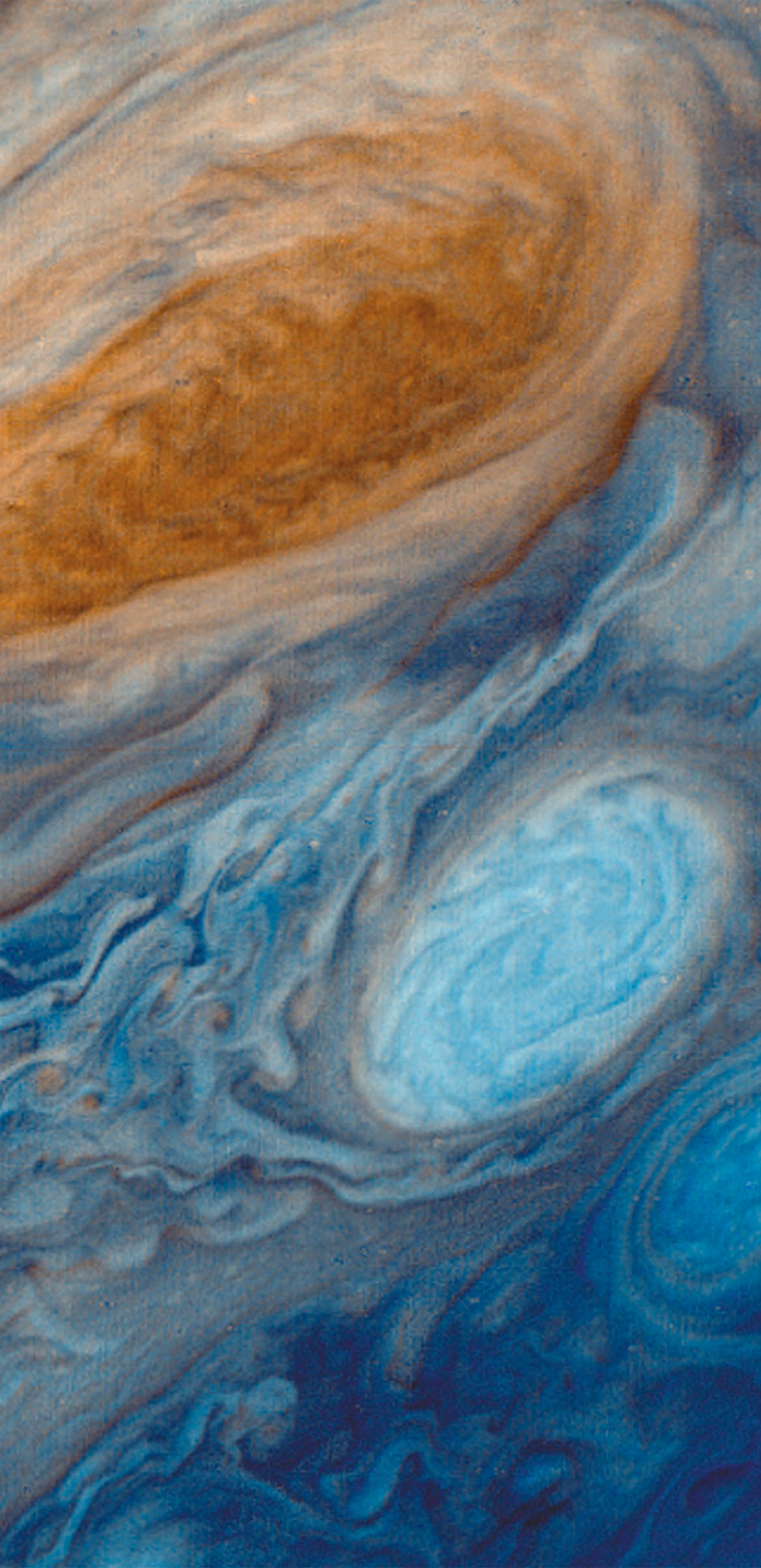
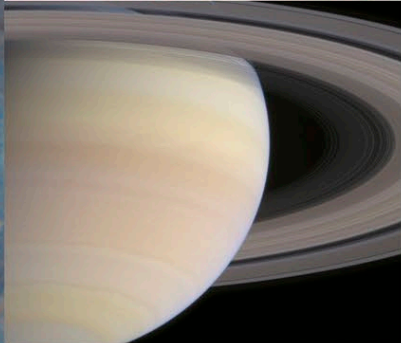




CANYONS ON MARS
4 light-minutes from Earth
Mars is one of the solar system's four inner rocky planets. This image (with exaggerated vertical scale) shows part of the Valles Marineris, a vast canyon system.



SATURN AND ITS RINGS
71 light-minutes from Earth
There are rings of dust and ice particles in nearly circular orbits around all four of the giant gas planets, but those around Saturn are especially beautiful. This close-up was taken by the Cassini spacecraft.



10
34 light-minutes from Earth
Jupiter has 79 known moons—and there are almost certainly others yet to be discovered. Io, Jupiter's innermost moon, is seen here moving in front of the turbulent face of the planet.



433 EROS
3.8 light-minutes from Earth
A vast number of asteroids are in independent orbit around the Sun. Eros is marked by the impact of much smaller bodies. This image was taken by the NEAR Shoemaker craft from only 60 miles (100 km) above the surface.

The planets

 **JUPITER'S GREAT RED SPOT**
34 light-minutes from Earth
The gas giant Jupiter is more massive than all of the other planets in the solar system combined. Its mysterious swirling vortex, the Great Red Spot, has been known since the 17th century, but our knowledge of Jupiter improved greatly when the planet was visited by uncrewed spacecraft in the 1970s. This image of the Great Red Spot was taken in 1979 by Voyager 1 using filters that exaggerate its colors.